It’s a Wonderful Life | Student Worksheet

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Directions: Write brief answers. Use character choices and scene evidence for analysis.

Before viewing

1. What can a counterfactual story help a viewer examine?

During viewing

2. What does George’s childhood rescue of Harry establish?

3. How do George’s travel ambitions shape our understanding of him?

4. Why does he remain involved with the Building and Loan?

5. How does George’s relationship with Mary complicate the idea of sacrifice?

6. What happens during the bank-run sequence?

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During viewing

7. How does Mary’s contribution affect that crisis?

8. Why does the missing deposit become a crisis for George?

9. How does George’s distress affect his interactions at home?

10. What do the neighbors’ actions at the end demonstrate?

After viewing

11. Which ordinary action has a large effect in the film’s argument?

12. What limitation should accompany discussion of the hopeful ending?

13. How does one repeated image, sound, or setting reinforce community?

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